if needed.

Sept. 12

N.S.C. on Lebanon. Things a little more quiet. A meeting there in Beirut as Gemayel attempts to get a cease fire. The Druse actually allowed the long delayed Red Cross column into the village where 40,000 Christian refugees have been besieged. . . .

Sept. 14

N.S.C: Saudi Arabia may exert more pressure on Syria. Things are a little suspended in Lebanon . . .

Sept. 19

N.S.C: Our Navy guns turned loose in support of the Lebanese army fighting to hold a position on a hill overlooking our Marines at the Beirut airport. This still comes under the head of defense. To allow those who have been shelling our marines to take that position would have made the Marine base untenable.

We met later—George Shultz, Cap W, etc., on a compromise we hope Congress will agree to regarding the War Powers Act and Congressional approval of the Marines being in Lebanon. Sen. Baker thinks he can get it through the Senate. Among other things it would settle their presence in Lebanon for 18 months.

Sept. 30

[Latest opinion polls] show I'm up on job rating, the economy. But on foreign policy—Lebanon—I'm way down. The people just don't know why we're there. There is deeply buried isolationist sentiment in our land.

After each marine was killed that September, I telephoned his parents and tried to console them. They were difficult,